

The Lust of Other Things

We have been studying the deceitfulness and craftiness of Satan. We have been studying the things he hides behind to effect your defeat.

We found out that Satan is a military genius. He has studied you and me for six thousand years. He knows what motivates us. His most powerful weapon is deceit.

As a matter of fact, he is so limited that he actually has to deceive you into accepting your own defeat, because Jesus gave you power over all the power of the enemy. You have more in the kingdom of God than he does in his kingdom.

Therefore, he has to use deceit to get you to accept your own defeat.

In Mark 4, in the parable of the sower, it declares that Satan comes immediately to remove the Word of God that is sown in our hearts. Then Jesus gives the five things Satan uses to remove that Word: persecutions, afflictions, cares of this life, deceitfulness of riches, and lusts of other things.

Satan hides behind these five things while he effects your defeat by removing the Word of God out of your heart.

He has deceived us into blaming these things on everyone else except who is really at fault, and that is the devil. Jesus said Satan comes immediately to remove the Word of God that is sown in our hearts.

We will call it our dog. "If I did not own that old dog, I could prosper."

We will call it our life, our job, our circumstances, where we live, our economy, or our nationality. He will blame it on anything but what is really hiding behind the smokescreen, and that is Satan.

When the Word of God unmasks him, we find out that persecutions, afflictions, cares of this life, deceitfulness of riches, and lusts of other things all arise for one reason: to remove or choke the Word of God before it can take root and produce your answers and mine.

We covered persecutions, afflictions, and cares of this life. For the last three days, we have been studying the deceitfulness of riches, because the deceitfulness of riches and lusts of other things are so interwoven with each other.

From now on, these next three nights, we are going to move back and forth between the deceitfulness of riches and the lusts of other things.

If Satan takes the same kind of beating these next three nights as he took over the last ones, I imagine he is pretty mad. I imagine he would rather you be any place but in this meeting. He would not mind if you were sitting in religion somewhere. He just does not want you sitting in life.

He does not want you finding out anything about the way he operates. He has had too much fun placing imaginations and thoughts into your minds, exalting himself against the knowledge of God, and then watching your reaction of dismay, despair, cares, and defeat, while you do not even know who is doing it.

Persecution basically comes from the outside. Cares of this life also arise from the outside and cause you to accept them. These are forces that arise around us and put pressure against us to remove the Word.

But after those three things, persecutions, afflictions, and cares of this life, he graduates to the deceitfulness of riches and finally the lusts of other things.

Now the pressure is not coming from the outside in. Now the pressure is dealing with the flesh. It is dealing against those natures.

He says:

Walk in the Spirit,
and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

The flesh wars against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the flesh, so that you cannot do the things that you would. But walk in the Spirit, and you will not fulfill the lust of the flesh.

These last two are the toughest. They come from within: the deceitfulness of riches and the lusts of other things. The other three came from without. They were pressure against us. These last two come from within, and they are the hardest to stand against.

They are the ones Satan reserves if the Word takes root and actually governs your life. If he cannot remove it by persecution, disease, afflictions, or heaping cares against you, then he switches his tactic and starts putting pressure against the lusts.

Now the pressure is coming from within, and brother, it is a different ballgame.

I can withstand things easier from without than I can from within. When we talk about the lusts of other things, we are talking about flesh, the forces of the flesh.

It was the flesh Paul was talking about when he spoke of the thorn in the flesh. Remember when he said:

Lest I should be exalted above measure
through the abundance of the revelations,
there was given to me a thorn in the flesh,
the messenger of Satan to buffet me.

Paul was getting close to God. He was seeing things he said were not lawful to utter. There was given to him a messenger of Satan, a messenger straight from the throne room of hell, with one purpose in mind. That devil was on assignment with one motivation and one goal in his existence: to neutralize the ministry of Paul.

Some scholars have broken the chapter down and said it was the pressure of a night and a day in the deep, being beaten with forty stripes save one, and the cares of the churches daily. They analyze the thorn in the flesh from the Old Testament, where an army surrounding the Jews became a thorn in their flesh. They say this devil excited persecution against Paul wherever he went.

I grant you that was part of it, but it was not the worst.

Paul cried three different times, "My God, help me. Make him depart from me." Three different times his heavenly Father said:

My grace is sufficient for thee.

I meditated on that for something like seven years. I broke the Greek down, took it apart, put it back together, and meditated until my meditator ached.

That is how I tested new translations. Somebody would say, "Have you ever seen this Bible?" I would flip right open to see what they said about Paul's thorn. Half of them said it was some kind of disease. Sometimes I would want to burn it to keep anybody else from getting it. I feel that strongly about the Word of God.

Three different times Paul cried, "My God, get this thing off me," and the answer God gave him pricked my spirit.

God said, "Paul, My grace is sufficient."

I said, "Lord, how could You say that? It sounds like You want to leave him in all this. It sounds like You do not want him delivered, only to trust Your grace. What are You trying to say?"

Persecutions he could have been delivered from. Jesus conveyed Himself away. Nobody could lay hands on Him because it was not His time. He said:

The works that I do shall he do also;
and greater works than these shall he do.

If conveying yourself away is one of His works, then let us do that too. I would much rather be led by the Spirit than beat up by the enemy.

The Lord's Prayer says to lead us around temptations, testings, trials, and the snares of the evil one. He has plenty of snares, but the leadership of the Spirit will lead you and me around them.

I have been led around a lot of them. The only time I have really been trapped is when I let things give me a little care or lust and said, "Let us capitalize on this." It was not maliciousness, but it tilted me off enough that I got beaten a couple of times. I do not like it.

But I know how to keep getting up. I just would not stay down.

The devil said, "You made a mistake."

I said, "I know it, but I am the fastest repentner you have ever seen. Once I repent, you cannot keep me down here. Let me out."

"But you did not pay it back."

"I am still forgiven. Let me out so I can go get the money. I cannot get the money living under all this condemnation."

I am restored to righteousness, and I am quick. I am convinced thirty seconds after I pray.

It was not all those persecutions. That was only fruit of what was going on.

Paul said, "My God, get this thing off me."

God said, "My grace is sufficient."

After my last long seeking time, I heard my Father say this inside, and I got so excited. I said, "Lord, I wanted to know that for so long."

He said, "You would not have understood it."

The reason He said, "My grace is sufficient," is because Paul was wearing a body just like yours and mine, given to him by the first Adam. It has death working in it. The thing will sin. It will fail. It will get mad. It will almost do anything if you let it.

The trumpet is going to sound by and by, and we are going to receive a body spawned from the loins of the last Adam, Jesus Christ. But while we are waiting on the sound of the trumpet, we have a body given to us by the first Adam.

Romans 8 says:

Whom he did predestinate,
them he also called:
and whom he called,
them he also justified:
and whom he justified,
them he also glorified.

Before the cross, He called them to the cross. At the cross, He justified them. Then He glorified them. We are not glorified yet, just as the people before the cross were not justified yet. But in the plan of God, we are, because He has taken it all the way through.

He called us to the cross. We made it that far. We are going to make it to glorification.

But now we have a body given to us by the first Adam, and that is where sin originates. It is capable of it.

You can turn around and slap the fire out of your husband. That did not come from the new creation realities in you.

You can get a rise when you get the bill for the new dress. That did not come from the new creation realities either.

Three times God said, "Paul, My grace is sufficient." That devil empowered the flesh. That is what he was doing through imaginations, persecutions, lust, and anything else he could use.

Paul said, "You received me in the infirmity of my flesh." It was not a disease he was talking about. Paul was going through hell. He withstood the same kinds of things some of you have withstood in the areas of imaginations and torments, only a thousand times worse.

I experienced some of it after my last seeking time. I saw a barrier. I saw a glorious realm that glowed like the sun, yet that glorious realm in God was blocked out by a black barrier you could not even see through.

I thought it was principalities and powers.

The Lord said, "No. I gave you power over them."

I said, "Then what is that black belt keeping us from seeing into that realm from where we are?"

He said, "Son, that is the flesh, and it has stopped more men of God than you can shake a stick at."

That is what this last one deals with, the lusts of other things entering in. If Satan cannot pressure you over, he will get inside and start building lusts for riches and other things until he pulls you over. He will push you or pull you, but in both cases he is still the enemy.

When God said, "My grace is sufficient," He was saying, "Paul, I cannot deliver you from your flesh. You will have to wait for the sound of the trumpet."

As far as the devil goes, God had already given Paul power over him.

So when Paul said:

Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities,
that the power of Christ may rest upon me.

He was saying that when Satan turns the pressures up to an ungodly high level, and a messenger straight from the throne room of hell can turn them up, those pressures strip him of dependency on the flesh and force his dependency totally onto the Spirit.

When he was in those weakened, beaten states, he found out he was strong because his dependency was totally on the realm of the Spirit.

That is the only way you are going to beat the lusts of other things entering in. You must learn how to walk after the Spirit.

The lusts of other things entering in choke the Word and render it unfruitful.

In the Spirit, as I gazed at that glorious realm, on the other side of that place were the missing parts for everyone who does not have an arm, a leg, or an eye.

I saw men finally break through that dark barrier. They soaked up that realm until they glowed like sunlight. When they came back, they looked like meteors shooting all over the earth. Wherever they landed, a little light began, and it grew until it met other lights, until the glory covered the earth as the waters cover the sea.

It was glorious wherever these men landed. Revival broke like nothing you had ever seen in your whole life. National news and satellite networks began to carry it. Reports came of men with no arms and no legs being made whole, until whole cities were turning out and standing on the banks, watching these men operate and convert entire cities and governments almost to God overnight.

Do you think that realm is not guarded? There are devils who have their life on the line to Satan. They do not want to be locked up. They guard that realm with their life. Any time a person has ever gotten close, they put devils on assignment to stop him.

That is when God began to bring to me the great men of God. I started knowing history on people without even reading about them. I started knowing what happened to them.

I saw great men and women of God throughout history pressing through that thing. Some got their hands through and came back with the mightiest healing anointings. Some got their head through and out-preached anything you ever heard.

I saw men pressing to get through that realm and then being stopped. It was the lusts of other things that neutralized them. It was the power in money and what it could buy: women, men, gratification. The ones who made it the furthest were finally neutralized through self-exaltation.

I remember one man of God, so powerful I do not even want to name his name. He was powerful. I have fifty of his tapes. I found the source and got them because I wanted to hear what the man taught.

Listening to those tapes, I thought, "My God, some of our trainees teach that well." But he had a gift.

Some Jehovah's Witnesses were affected when one of their higher-up relatives was converted in one of William Branham's meetings. This young man had polio legs, little bitty legs. Branham called him out, prayed, and he was healed.

He went back among the higher-ups, and they got mad. So they sent one of the higher-ups to get him.

The man came into Branham's house and said, "What is this?"

Branham said, "Sit down."

The man kept going on and on.

Branham said, "Look, friend, I know where you were last Thursday night. Does your wife know you are sleeping with your secretary?"

The man said, "My God, what do I have to do to be saved?"

Branham told him his conversation, and the man went back born again.

Then they sent the top man up. The Lord told Branham, "Take him fishing."

So Branham took him fishing. The man caught a little fish, which Branham had told him he was going to catch. He said, "I am going to catch a big one, and you are going to catch a little one. That is all you are going to get."

The man caught this little fish, and he did not want to take time with it. He jerked the hook and jerked the guts out. The guts were floating there, and the little fish was floating there.

All of a sudden a swirl came in the trees, a light, with leaves swirling all over. This light stopped by Branham and said, "Speak to the fish."

Branham said, "Come alive, little fish," and it turned up and swam.

The man said, "That is it. I want to get saved."

Yet I believe it was down in Shreveport, Louisiana, when a woman turned to Branham and said, "Yea, thou art Elijah that is to come."

He said, "I know it, sister. God has been telling me."

If Satan cannot get you with lust, if money will not buy you, if women, men, or gratification will not buy you, then the lusts of other things will exalt you. He will get behind you and push you over.

Some people say, "I would rather go nowhere."

It is not really your choice. Every one of us has a prospective position in the body of Christ to fulfill. You will be rewarded according to the basis of how much you fulfill.

Of course Satan is going to try to stop you. But he does not have enough power, especially if you know who is launching the attack.

The lusts of other things, which correlate with the deceitfulness of riches, enter in, choke the Word of God, and render it unfruitful before it can produce the hundredfold and all the best God has.

Let me show you an interesting happening in Mark 6. I meditated in this and thought, "My God, this is what we are talking about."

Jesus was working miracles, and He anointed people to work miracles. Herod heard of it, and it scared him badly. He thought John the Baptist had risen from the dead. He was scared because he knew John was a just, devout, holy man.

Mark 6:14 says:

And king Herod heard of him;
for his name was spread abroad:
and he said,
That John the Baptist was risen from the dead,
and therefore mighty works do shew forth themselves in him.

Others said it was Elijah, or one of the prophets. But when Herod heard, he said:

It is John,
whom I beheaded:
he is risen from the dead.

Herod was scared because of the conditions of John's death.

For Herod himself had sent forth
and laid hold upon John,
and bound him in prison
for Herodias' sake,
his brother Philip's wife:
for he had married her.

It looks like the same thing was going on then that goes on now. This must have been one of the most beautiful women in the world. If you do not think we have a woman here who wanted nothing but power, we do. She did not leave Philip for Herod because she loved Herod. She left Philip for Herod because of Herod's position.

John had said unto Herod:

It is not lawful for thee
to have thy brother's wife.

Therefore Herodias had a quarrel against him and would have killed him, but she could not. Herod would not consent to John's death because he feared him. He feared his righteousness.

Herod was actually listening to and doing many of John's teachings:

For Herod feared John,
knowing that he was a just man and an holy,
and observed him;
and when he heard him,
he did many things,
and heard him gladly.

That word "observed" means he observed to do what John preached. Herod was actually conforming to John's teachings, and in doing so, the marriage was put in question. That was the quarrel Herodias had against John, but she could not get Herod to execute him because Herod was afraid of the man's righteousness.

I like finding something like that in a den of iniquity. It makes me want to praise God for righteousness and true holiness preachers.

Mark 6:21 says:

And when a convenient day was come,
that Herod on his birthday
made a supper to his lords,
high captains,
and chief estates of Galilee;
And when the daughter of the said Herodias came in,
and danced,
and pleased Herod and them that sat with him,
the king said unto the damsel,
Ask of me whatsoever thou wilt,
and I will give it thee.

He swore unto her:

Whatsoever thou shalt ask of me,
I will give it thee,
unto the half of my kingdom.

I got to listening to the Holy Ghost about this. There was a whole lot more going on than the surface account. I wondered why this thing was so drastic. Herodias' daughter danced before Herod and his chief estates, and it pleased him so much that he wanted to give away up to half his kingdom.

I said, "Why, God? Over a dance?"

Then it dawned on me. I have been in righteous circles too long, among preachers and prayer rooms and meetings. I live a sheltered life. I forget how the world thinks.

Herodias' daughter was not Herod's daughter by marriage. She may have been Philip's daughter or from someone before him. But Herod was not offering half his kingdom over a dance.

Before all those witnesses, he said, "I will give you up to half my kingdom."

Even though he feared and lived by many of the teachings of that righteous teacher, when the lusts of other things entered in, Herod sold John out.

The girl went forth and said unto her mother:

What shall I ask?

Her mother said:

The head of John the Baptist.

Do not kid yourself. Her mother sold out her daughter because of arrogant pride and the lusts of other things. The insult of her self-exalted pride caused her to sell her daughter out. She had this planned.

The girl came straightway with haste unto the king and asked:

I will that thou give me
by and by in a charger
the head of John the Baptist.

The king was exceedingly sorry, yet for the oath's sake and for their sakes which sat with him, he would not reject her. Immediately the king sent an executioner and commanded John's head to be brought. He went and beheaded him in prison, brought his head in a charger, gave it to the damsel, and the damsel gave it to her mother.

When John's disciples heard of it, they came, took up his corpse, and laid it in a tomb.

Then the apostles gathered themselves together unto Jesus and told Him all things, both what they had done and what they had taught.

Jesus said unto them:

Come ye yourselves apart
into a desert place,
and rest a while.

There were many coming and going, and they had no leisure even to eat.

John the Baptist was the cousin of Jesus Christ. But besides being kindred, there was not another man on the face of the earth as united in spirit with Jesus as John the Baptist.

Jesus said of John:

Among them that are born of women
there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist.

The strange thing to me is that John the Baptist did no miracles. Elijah and Elisha performed miracles that could turn nations: raising the dead, calling fire down from heaven. Yet Jesus did not say, "Born of women, there is no greater prophet than Moses or Elijah." He said John was much more than a prophet.

He said John was the one spoken of by God before he came, the one who would preach and make the pathway straight to prepare the way for the Messiah.

Yet Jesus turned around to you and me and said:

Notwithstanding he that is least
in the kingdom of heaven
is greater than he.

I hope you do not think He meant stature or equality. He meant the least in the kingdom of God is a new creation, filled with the Holy Ghost, and has more access to the revealing, attributes, and sonship of God than John the Baptist ever had.

When the news came to Jesus, there was an opportunity to take care, persecution, and affliction. If my son or a good friend were sacrificed honorably, we could understand that. But to be the victim of a drunken, lustful oath at the hands of a power-hungry woman for the gratification of the flesh, what a way to die.

When the news reached Jesus, He said, "We do not have time to eat. We do not have time to sleep. We have been ministering to so many people coming and going."

If that kind of news reached me, I know what I would want to do. I would want to depart into a desert place and be alone. "Could you guys just leave me alone for a little while?"

Or I might want to gather all my followers. At that time, the whole common population was coming to Jesus. The priests knew they were losing their hold over the multitudes. Jesus had a following that could have stormed Herod's palace.

But Jesus did not retaliate in the flesh.

How did Jesus handle it?

Mark 6:33 says:

And the people saw them departing,
and many knew him,
and ran afoot thither out of all cities,
and outwent them,
and came together unto him.

All Jesus wanted to do was depart to a desert place to be alone. When the crowd saw Him leave and knew where He was going, they outran Him and were waiting for Him when He got there.

Can you imagine five thousand people and their families waiting for Him to dock?

When Jesus saw the whole crowd, He was moved with compassion.

He did not retaliate in the natural. He took five thousand men and their families, began to teach them many parables and secrets of the kingdom of God, and healed their sick. He took fish and loaves and fed them.

He retaliated in the Spirit and got the devil off ten thousand people.

How do you want to retaliate?

Jesus reached further out in the Spirit than He had ever been and got the devil off of multitudes. Did the devil pay for beheading John the Baptist? Yes, he did.

After Jesus got the devil off the five thousand, taught them mysteries in the kingdom, and fed them, He finally sent His disciples away into the sea and departed into a mountain to pray.

Mark 6:45 says:

And straightway he constrained his disciples
to get into the ship,
and to go to the other side before unto Bethsaida,
while he sent away the people.
And when he had sent them away,
he departed into a mountain to pray.

When evening came, the ship was in the midst of the sea, and He was alone on the land.

Then it says:

And he saw them toiling in rowing;
for the wind was contrary unto them.

If they were in the middle of the sea, He was alone on the land, and it was night, how could He see them toiling and rowing?

That is the benefit of an intercessor.

The devil had beheaded John the Baptist. When the news came to Jesus, He wanted to be alone. But He was moved with compassion and reached out in the Spirit and tore the devil off about ten thousand people. He retaliated and made the devil pay badly.

So the devil watched closely and said, "Aha, Jesus and the disciples are separated. When they get out in the middle of the sea, I am going to kill them."

Except for one problem: Jesus has His own television.

The devil was not going to kill them, just like he is not going to kill your family. That is the benefit of an intercessor.

About the fourth watch of the night, Jesus came unto them, walking upon the sea.

The text says He "would have passed by them." The Greek actually carries the sense that He was passing from the side of the land to the side of the ship. Why would He have the vision if He was just going to stroll on by?

When they saw Him walking on the sea, they supposed He had been a spirit and cried out. They were not calmly asking, "Who are You?" They were terrified.

Immediately He talked unto them and said:

Be of good cheer:
it is I;
be not afraid.

He went up unto them into the ship, and the wind ceased. They were amazed beyond measure and wondered, because they had not considered the miracle of the loaves, for their heart was hardened.

That is another teaching.

We are on the lusts of the flesh and on retaliation. Tomorrow night we will continue another step.